

Display screens with sensors

Makers of Gorilla Glass along with researchers from Polytechnique Montreal are trying to build transparent sensors on display glasses <http://dgit.in/TransparentSensors>

**World's first E-ink wall clock**

E-ink which is usually used in e-book readers like the Kindle is being used on the Twelve24 ClockONE <http://dgit.in/eInkClock>

Security matters with McAfee

Our first interview with McAfee after they were bought over by Intel. On his maiden visit to India, we spoke with John Giamatteo, SVP and GM, Consumer Business, McAfee on all things related to security, including McAfee India, the fallibility of Android, Bitcoins and how rise of apps and devices is impacting the threat landscape.

Jayesh Shinde

jayesh.shinde@digit.in

What's changed for McAfee after the Intel buyout? What's new and exciting as opposed to when you were operating independently?

John: For a period of time the company was operating as a standalone organization within the Intel family. There were a number of projects where we would collaborate, both in terms of software and hardware, and it was low-hanging fruit of collaboration. Towards the end of 2013, and starting Q1 2014, we're starting to see the two companies come together in a much more collaborative way. With the start of the Intel Security Group, that was the step in the right direction in bringing closer the leadership and the performance and the trust of the Intel products from a hardware perspective and bringing McAfee and the software leadership that we have in having security be a pillar of the overall solution and value proposition that Intel brings to the market. In this year, you'll see a much deeper level of collaboration, you'll probably see us launch some products together. At the CPU level, we've some products in the pipeline that share Intel and McAfee technologies.

Any comment on the kind of work McAfee India's doing and how it's contributing to the global vision?

John: The engineers here at McAfee India, working on projects across all parts of the business, are very instrumental to everything that we do as a company. McAfee has strong global partnerships all over the world; companies like HP and Dell on the PC side, Docomo and Vodafone on the mobile side, and relationships with ISPs like



John Giamatteo, SVP and GM, Consumer Business, McAfee

Airtel, Singtel. The team here in Bangalore provides an incredible amount of focus on ensuring that we build the best products and deliver them with our partners in a very comprehensive way that creates values for our partners, us and our consumers in providing protection around the world. The team here does all sorts of different works from partnership implementations to platform engineering and performance fine tuning. That's one of the reasons why we were able to achieve such a good rating on the most recent AV Test. We also do innovations here in McAfee India, coming up with new products and services. We're very excited about mobile, especially in markets like here in India. The team here is definitely the cornerstone and the centrepiece of a lot of that work that we do around the world.

Can you tell me about LiveSafe?

John: We ship it on a direct basis, we ship

it with our partners. And we've received very good feedback from the usability standpoint. Since it's a multi-device product, consumers can not only protect their PCs but seamlessly add other devices to their protection. It's a very comprehensive product, and as more devices come online, a product like LiveSafe will be the centrepiece of a cross-device security solution for more and more consumers.

What are some of the unique capabilities of LiveSafe that elevate it above competitors?

John: I think there are a few things that it does really well. The biometrics file locker is a unique capability that really protects the consumer's data in a slightly different way from traditional security software. The other aspect is the ease with which consumers can extend security to other devices through LiveSafe. It literally takes a few clicks from extending security from a PC to an Android tablet or smartphone.

As a platform, has Android become the Windows of PC era when it comes to malware infections?

John: I think it's fair to say that the Android platform – while excellent in many ways – seems to be more susceptible for infections because of its inherently open nature. Which is why a lot of our products attract a lot of interest from Android users.

Do you think the whole concept of Bitcoin malignant in nature?

John: Absolutely. I think all of these things are avenues for some of the bad guys to get in there and do some damage or collect some information that they shouldn't have. 